years.

‘I know he praised Nehru at the award ceremony and told the gathering that all his life he only followed the path shown by the Indian leader. He was beaming with joy recounting his encounter with Nehru,’ Jindal replied in a lighter vein.

‘You called me to discuss the friendship between Bruno and Nehru?’ Sophie looked straight into his eyes before lighting a cigarette.

‘You don’t need to be sarcastic.’ Jindal was defensive.

‘What do you expect after showing up suddenly after two years? I don’t know whether you are a friend or a foe/ Sophie snapped.

Jindal was silent. He was not an amateur. Abandoning the source was a part of his job. But renewing contact with a subconscious agent was something he had never done before.

‘Just be honest with me. I am getting worried about your sudden reappearance/ said Sophie.

‘Do you know where Harpreet Ahuja is?’ Jindal asked.

‘The Indian guy who worked with our organisation? He left about a year ago. Why are you looking for him?’

‘I want you to dig him out for me/ Jindal said, placing an envelope containing $10,000 on the table.

Sophie looked at him quietly. She took the envelope and got up.